Another open point for variables (and functions etc…) is the naming convention used. This is not something that a programming language will force (usually), but rather a convention that stems from the community and from guidelines.

We will use *camel-case* for names, not for any technical reason or preference towards one programming language, but just because it uses less characters than *snake-case*, and that makes it easier to fit code on a book page.

So, for instance, we will use *doAction* rather than *do_action* for a function name, and something like *RedBox* for a class or object.

There are a few basic operations on variables that are needed to interact with them:

- Assigning to a variable: we use a left-pointing arrow, for instance `index ← 1` assigns the value 1 to a variable named “index”.
- Reading a variable value: we just use the variable name, and that becomes a placeholder for the value held by the variable when that line of code is executed: `index ← size` reads the value of the variable size and assigns it to `index`.
- Comparing values:
  - We use two equal characters to compare two variables or values[1] for equality: `index == size` or `index == 1` are two examples, the former comparing two variables, the latter comparing a variable and a value.